Interview Questions – Part B: Open-Ended Qualitative Questions (50 minutes)

Now, I would like to ask some questions to understand your experiences with buying and preparing food and using food assistance programs (such as SNAP or food stamps, food pantries, and school lunch programs) and how refugee organizations have helped you with food.

Questions on food and nutrition insecurity experiences and using food programs (40 minutes)

1. Tell me about your experience in buying and preparing food for your household in the U.S.
    a. Explore where they buy food and groceries, if they have cooking appliances, and if they know how to cook food.

Yeah everything is good. Same like my country. (Where do you get your groceries from?) Costco, Winco, Walmart, smiths. Big thing like water, flour, oil in Costco. Vegetable and other things Winco,Walmart, Rancho market.

2. Review answers in the Food Insecurity sections and ask the following questions if they have experienced food insecurity in the last 12 months; if not, go to question #3:
    a. You indicated that you often/sometimes had problems with food in the last 12 months, can you tell me more about that?

No, good it was good. (making sure you have enough food for the family?) yeah it was good because if my husband more working he can buy, he less working I have enough. I know everything is crazy, very expensive.

        i. Explore the nature of the problem such as unemployment, low income, language barriers, and lack of knowledge about resources.

    b. Can you explain what you did to find help with food and if that worked?

(how was your snap experience?) It was good, when I came to the US, I still have clothing (note to Dr. Nasser, this part was not really understandable.) Like fresh fruit, vegetable, everything when I buy I cook here. I don't want to buy cooked.

    c. Can you explain how your <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> helped you with food?

CCS

They didn't help, he just supplies for home. (they provided you with supplies to cook food?) yeah. (what kind of supplies did they get you?) **participant did not answer.**

IRC

Irc they give like flour, oil, stuff like that but CCS no. Just home supplies they can not give you like food. IRC they gives a lot. In the winter like a flour and oil, pasta, a lot of things. Cleaning supplies, IRC good, CCS was 6 months.

        i. Explore training on budget management, preparing meals, purchasing foods, using food pantries and farmers markets, and applying for food programs such as SNAP.

ii. What has been most useful to you among things that your <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> do?

IRC

We use flour a lot, they do flour in the winter. My baby was small they give me formula a lot. IRc they give you like garden you know. That's too much, also now they do the card we go buy there fresh vegetables. IRC is the best. They very good, when they help something, I tell my friends and they go.

iii. Ask those who are still receiving <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> support: Do you feel comfortable finding help with food without the help of <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> when you graduate from <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY>?

They do the program in winter, just for the people in the garden. (what if that program ended, would you be comfortable finding food on your own?) Maybe, yeah, maybe other way.

iv. Is there anything that you wish you had learned or could learn from caseworkers of <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> to help you with food?

No

d. Ask those who graduated from <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> to determine when food became a problem: Can you tell me when food became a problem?

CCS can not help, just IRC can help. If they give us okay its okay. If they didn't no problem.

e. Review answers in the Utilization section and ask the following questions if they have used SNAP/WIC/NSLP/Food Pantries/Other programs in the last 12 months; if not go to #f below:
   i. You indicated that you have used XXX program, can you tell me how you heard about this program and how you applied for it?
   ii. Can you explain your experience with using this program? Explore how often they use the program and how they feel about it.
   iii. Tell me about the food you received from them.
   iv. What % of your foods come from this program?

SNAP:

You indicated that you have used XXX program, can you tell me how you heard about this program and how you applied for it?

When we came to America. (was it through your agency?) CCS. (they helped you?) yeah. (did they do it for you or did they show you how to do it?) They make caseworker everything, they do, first day. (they taught you how to do it?) yeah

We came and you know which things we buy in our country, we buy just that. Not the bar or the other things, we buy like fresh vegetables, meat, chicken.

FQ: were you able to find everything?

Yeah yeah, same yeah. It was same like my country the food is, they have everything. Because they know the community they telling you, this food is good. The first time they are rancho. They show us rancho, they have everything. Cheaper.

Can you explain your experience with using this program?

Yeah yeah, good no tax.

FQ: you told me the food you get with SNAP was like flour and oil and stuff like pasta, and fresh fruits and vegetables.

Yeah

What % of your foods come from this program?

800 (like 800 dollars a month) yeah, (how much do you spend on groceries?) more than 800. But we use 300 more.

3. Tell me about your experience in finding and buying foods from your culture.
    a. How important eating foods from your culture is to you?

Yeah, same like my country people eating chicken, lamb, beef. Like a BBQ, same like my country. (So you bring foods from your country here?) yeah. Now I make with different vegetables in America, but no same in my country.

    b. Where do you get your vegetables and cultural foods from?

Rancho, winco, every store has. Rancho has same.

    c. How does/did <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> help you with finding foods from your culture?
        i. What did they do that was the most helpful and why?

IRC

No

    d. Do you use Farmers Market to buy foods from your culture?

Yeah, same my country

    e. Have you used the Sunnyvale Farmers Market (4013 S 700 W)?
        i. if yes, how did you hear about it and what has been your experience with that?

Yeah, the vegetable, the last five years. Good, very good. For all communities good.

    f. Ask those who have used New Roots: Can you describe your experience with the New Roots program (also known as IRC Garden or IRC Farm Program)?
        i. Did this program give you more food to eat? please explain.

Yeah that's very good, for two three months very good. Every Wednesday, Thursday, Saturday. Just two – three months.

ii. Can you describe the training you received in this program?
no

iii. Can you explain whether and how this program has helped you in any ways?
Very good, yeah a lot. I bring every Saturday and Wednesday a lot of cucumber and mint and coriander. Its good for two – three for the winter we eat fresh vegetables.

Suggestions for future strategies to improve food access (10 minutes)

READ TO PARTICIPANT: This is the last section of our interview and I would like to ask your suggestions on how to improve food security among refugees.

1. What do you think keeps people from your community from using food assistance programs that are available to them?

They have a snap everyone who have a low income.

FQ: have you ever met someone who has a low income but is not using it?

No they know everything. Everyone smart.

2. How do you think we can ensure that refugees can access food assistance programs when they need help with food?

They go refugee center.

FQ: so you think the refugee center should be open for people all the time?

For apply for SNAP and everything else

FQ: what if it is late at night and they realized they ran out of food?

I think they have to save money, everyone smart now, everyone save money.

FQ: you think if there was a food pantry at IRC available that would be good?

Yeah

FQ: is there something like. That?

No they don't have it.

3. What do you think <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> and other refugee organizations can do to ensure refugees have enough food?

I don't know. I don't go a lot outside.

FQ: what would make your life a lot easier?

We right now we have a lot limitation to what we can do.

FQ: you think if you had access to food coming to you that would help you?

Yeah that would be so easy.

4. Do you want to share anything else regarding your experiences with food insecurity and using food assistance programs since you moved to the U.S. and since you graduated from <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY>?

No.